The `Build` method returns the configured application as an instance of the `WebApplication` type. This type represents a merger of three other types:

- `IApplicationBuilder`—Allows configuration of the application's request, or middleware pipeline
- `IEndpointRouteBuilder`—Enables the configuration of mapping incoming requests to specific pages
- `IHost`—Provides the means to start and stop the application

The `WebApplication` allows you to register middleware components to build and configure the application's request pipeline. For now, let's take a high-level look at the default configuration in the following listing. You will learn about the more interesting parts of the pipeline in detail later in the book.

Listing 2.7 The default request pipeline

```
if (!app.Environment.IsDevelopment())
{
    app.UseExceptionHandler("/Error");
    app.UseHsts();
}
app.UseHttpsRedirection();
app.UseStaticFiles();
app.UseRouting();
app.UseAuthorization();
app.MapRazorPages();
app.Run();
```

Each middleware is added to the pipeline via an extension method on the `IApplicationBuilder` type, which is implemented by `WebApplication`. An `IWebHost- Environment` is accessible via the `Environment` property, which holds information about the current environment. You will learn more about environments in